

[Lesson 27](#): “They Must Needs Be Chastened and Tried, Even as Abraham” (See L27 [Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To learn about the early Saints’ efforts to establish the city of Zion in Missouri and to encourage us to help build Zion today.

1. The Saints settle in Jackson County, Missouri, and are later driven out.

†1. Historical Background

2. The Lord instructs the Saints who were driven from Jackson County.

As “word of the troubles in Missouri reached Joseph Smith in Kirtland, he was deeply distressed. He prayed concerning the redemption of Zion and received the revelation that is now D&C 101.” (*Lesson Manual*)

• D&C 101:1-8 What reasons did the Lord give for allowing afflictions to come upon the Saints in Missouri?

†2. Reasons for allowing Saints’ afflictions †3. A Need to Repent

For what purposes does the Lord chasten His people? (See D&C 95:1; 105:6; Hel. 12:3; and Heb. 12:11.)

How is the Lord’s chastening a demonstration of His love for us?

How can we eagerly remember God “in the day of [our] peace”?

How did the Lord show compassion for the Saints after chastening them? †4. The Lord’s compassion

How have you felt the Lord’s “tender mercies” in times of special need?

• D&C 101:35-38. “And all they who suffer persecution for my name, and endure in faith ...”

What can we learn from these verses to help us keep a righteous perspective?

How has a knowledge of the Lord’s eternal promises helped you in times of trial?

3. Zion’s Camp is organized and marches to Missouri.

After “the Saints were driven from Jackson County, they petitioned Governor Daniel Dunklin of Missouri for assistance in restoring their homes and for protection. The governor expressed a willingness to help if the Saints would organize a group of men to march nearly 1,000 miles to carry relief to the Saints in Missouri, help them return to their lands, and protect them afterward. The revelation giving directions for this expedition, which came to be known as Zion’s Camp, is recorded in D&C 103.” (See “[Training of Leaders in Zion’s Camp](#),” and “[Persecution of Zion’s Camp](#),” in *Our Heritage*, pages 27-29 and 44-45. See map 3 on page 31 in the *Class Member Study Guide*.) (*Lesson Manual*)

“After the camp had traveled nearly 1,000 miles to Fishing River, near Jackson County, the Lord revealed that the Saints would have to wait for the redemption of Zion. Soon afterward, the Prophet disbanded the camp.”

“When Brigham Young returned to Kirtland after Zion’s Camp, he was asked, ‘What have you gained by this journey?’ He replied, ‘Just what we went for; ... I would not exchange the knowledge I have received this season for the whole of [this] County’ (in *Journal of Discourses*, 2:10). (*Lesson Manual*)

What important purposes did Zion’s Camp accomplish? †5. The value of Zion’s Camp

How did the experience of Zion’s Camp prepare future leaders of the Church? †6. In February 1835

What can we learn from the experiences of Zion’s Camp? †7. The lessons of Zion’s Camp

†8. Orson F. Whitney †9. Elder Robert D. Hales †10. President Harold B. Lee

4. The Lord reveals that His people must “wait for a little season for the redemption of Zion.”

The “Lord had promised to redeem Zion and restore His people to their lands in Jackson County, Missouri. However, this promise was conditioned on the Saints’ obedience ([D&C 103:5–8, 11–14](#)). Just as ancient Israel was not able to enter the promised land for 40 years because of their disobedience, the Lord revealed that modern Israel would have to “wait for a little season” for the redemption of Zion because of the disobedience and dissension of some Saints ([D&C 105:9, 13](#)). (*Lesson Manual*)

• D&C 105:1-13. What are some of the requirements the Lord gave for the eventual establishment of Zion?

†11. Requirements for the establishment of Zion

• D&C 105:38-40. The “Lord counseled the Saints to seek peace, even with those who had persecuted them. He promised that in return, ‘all things shall work together for your good’ (D&C 105:40).” (*Lesson Manual*)

How have you been blessed as you have applied the counsel to seek peace?

†12. Selections from *Doctrine and Covenants Manual: Religion 324 and 325*

Next Week: L28: “O God, Where Art Thou?”; See L28 [Class Member Study Guide](#).

(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [Doctrine and Covenants Manual: Religion 324 and 325](#).) † •

†1. Historical Background: From “1831 to 1838, the Church had two centers of population—one in Kirtland, Ohio, and the other in western Missouri. Important events were happening in both places. Lessons 27 and 28 focus on doctrines and events associated with the Church in Missouri.

“In July 1831, Joseph Smith made his first journey to Missouri. There he received a revelation designating Missouri as the place for the city of Zion, with Independence as the center place (D&C 57:1–3). On 2 August, Sidney Rigdon dedicated the land for the gathering of the Saints. The next day the Prophet Joseph Smith dedicated the temple site in Independence.

“Members from the Colesville Branch in New York were the first Saints to settle Missouri, and others soon gathered there, eager to help build the city of Zion (D&C 63:24, 36). By 1832 there were more than 800 Saints gathered into five branches in Independence and the surrounding areas of Jackson County.

“The Saints in Jackson County enjoyed a time of peace and optimism. However, problems arose in late 1832. Some members would not accept the authority of their local Church leaders. Others criticized the Prophet Joseph, who had returned to Kirtland. Some members were contentious, covetous, selfish, and unbelieving.

“In addition, tensions with other settlers in the area were increasing. On 20 July 1833, these tensions escalated into violence. (See “[Persecution in Jackson County](#)” and “[Tarring and Feathering of Bishop Partridge](#)” from *Our Heritage*, pages 39-40 and 41-42.)

“Between July and November 1833, persecutions against the Saints intensified. Mobs burned their crops, destroyed their homes, whipped and beat the men, and terrorized the women and children.

“On 4 November, near the Big Blue River, members of the mob began a battle against a small group of Latter-day Saint men and boys (See “[Battle of the Big Blue](#),” *Our Heritage*, pages 42-43). During the next two days more than 1,000 Saints were driven from Jackson County in the bitter cold. Destitute, most of them crossed the Missouri River and found temporary refuge in Clay County. (See “[Refuge in Clay County](#),” from *Our Heritage*, pages 43-44.) (*Lesson Manual*)

†2. Reasons for allowing Saints’ afflictions:

a. D&C 101:2, 6. Because of their transgressions, e.g. “jarrings, and contentions, and envyings, and strifes, and lustful and covetous desires,” and because “they did not hearken altogether to the precepts and commandments which I [God] gave unto them.” (103:4).

b. D&C 101:4. “Therefore, they must needs be chastened and tried, even as Abraham”.

c. D&C 101:7-8. “They were slow to hearken unto the voice of the Lord their God; therefore, the Lord their God is slow to hearken unto their prayers, to answer them in the day of their trouble.” (*LM*)

†3. A Need to Repent: “Petty jealousies, covetousness, light mindedness, unbelief, and general neglect in keeping the commandments came to the attention of the Prophet. Some people in Zion even charged Joseph Smith with ‘seeking after monarchical power and authority’ and said he was purposely putting off settling in Zion” (*Church History In The Fulness Of Times Student Manual*, (2003), 127-139 see “[A Need to Repent](#)”).

†4. The Lord’s compassion

a. D&C 101:9. He promised not to cast them off and He promised to be merciful “in the day of wrath.”

b. D&C 101:10. He promised His indignation would fall on their enemies.

c. D&C 101:11-15. He promised to save, gather, and comfort His Saints.

d. D&C 101:16-19. He promised to redeem Zion in the future. (*Lesson Manual*)

†5. The value of Zion’s Camp

a. The participants were strengthened by several miraculous manifestations of the Lord’s power (see “[Persecution of Zion’s Camp](#),” *Our Heritage*, ages 44–45, for one example).

b. It provided an opportunity to try the faith of the participants, allowing them to prove that they would obey the Lord and sacrifice all things, even their lives if necessary, to do His will.

c. It served as a proving ground to determine who was faithful to serve in positions of Church leadership.

d. It gave participants an opportunity to associate closely with the Prophet and learn from him, preparing them for future leadership responsibilities. (*LM*)

Recommended Reading:

1. Elder David A. Bednar, “[The Tender Mercies of the Lord](#),” *Ensign*, May 2005.

2. William C. Beardall, “[Zion—The Pure in Heart](#),” presents a very fine recap of the problems in Missouri.

3. Meridian Magazine Staff member, “[Doctrine & Covenants Lesson 27](#).”

4. Orson F. Whitney, *The Life of Heber C. Kimball*, [Chapter 9](#).

5. Nancy R. Jensen, “[They Must Be Chastened and Tried](#).”

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†6. In February 1835, five months after the camp was disbanded, the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles and the First Quorum of the Seventy were organized. Nine of the Twelve Apostles and all 70 members of the Quorum of the Seventy had served in Zion's Camp. Speaking of how the camp helped prepare these leaders, Joseph Smith said:

"Brethren, some of you are angry with me, because you did not fight in Missouri; but let me tell you, God did not want you to fight. He could not organize His kingdom with twelve men to open the Gospel door to the nations of the earth, and with seventy men under their direction to follow in their tracks, unless He took them from a body of men who had offered their lives, and who had made as great a sacrifice as did Abraham" (History of the Church, 2:182).

The experience of George A. Smith demonstrates how Zion's Camp prepared men for future leadership in the Church. At age 16, he was the youngest man in the camp, inexperienced and lacking confidence. Despite personal discomfort and the complaints of many men about the poor conditions, George willingly followed all of Joseph Smith's instructions. George slept in the Prophet's tent and was able to hear much of his counsel and instructions. By closely associating with the Prophet, George learned leadership skills and developed strength that prepared him for a lifetime of leadership. Less than five years after Zion's Camp, George A. Smith was ordained an Apostle. He later served with Brigham Young as a member of the First Presidency." (*Lesson Manual*)

†7. The lessons of Zion's Camp

- a. An understanding of the purposes of trials. (D&C 103:12.)
- b. The importance of obedience. (D&C 103:7-10, 36.)
- c. The need to be willing to sacrifice all things for the Lord. (See D&C 103:27-28.)
- d. The importance of being unified in the Lord's work. When even a few people murmur and rebel, the entire group is weakened.
- e. The importance of sustaining the prophet and following his counsel even when it is difficult or when we do not fully understand the reasons for it. (*LM*)

†8. Orson F. Whitney: "Ah, reader, the redemption of Zion is more than the purchase or recovery of lands, the building of cities, or even the founding of nations. It is the conquest of the heart, the subjugation of the soul, the sanctifying of the flesh, the purifying and ennobling of the passions. Greater is he who subdues himself, who captures and maintains the citadel of his own soul, than he who, misnamed conqueror, fills the world with the roar of drums, the thunder of cannon, the lightning of swords and bayonets, overturns and

sets up kingdoms, lives and reigns a king, yet wears to the grave the fetters of unbridled lust, and dies the slave.

"In her children's hearts must Zion first be built up and redeemed; 'every man seeking the interest of his neighbor, and doing all things with an eye single to the glory of God'" (in *Life of Heber C. Kimball*, 65 and 66).

†9. Elder Robert D. Hales: "This promised Zion always seems to be a little beyond our reach. We need to understand that as much virtue can be gained in progressing toward Zion as in dwelling there. It is a process as well as a destination. We approach or withdraw from Zion through the manner in which we conduct our daily dealings, how we live within our families, whether we pay an honest tithe and generous fast offering, how we seize opportunities to serve and do so diligently. Many are perfected upon the road to Zion who will never see the city in mortality" ("Welfare Principles to Guide Our Lives: An Eternal Plan for the Welfare of Men's Souls," *Ensign*, May 1986).

†10. President Harold B. Lee: "Don't be afraid of the testing and trials of life. Sometimes when you are going through the most severe tests, you will be nearer to God than you have any idea, for like the experience of the Master himself in the temptation on the mount, in the Garden of Gethsemane, and on the cross at Calvary, the scriptures record, 'And, behold, angels came and ministered unto him.' (Matthew 4:11.) Sometimes that may happen to you in the midst of your trials." (In Conference Report, Munich Germany Area Conference 1973, p. 114.) (In *Doctrine and Covenants Manual: Religion 324 and 325*, 238-239.)

†11. Requirements for the establishment of Zion

- a. The Saints must learn obedience (D&C 105:3, 6; and 105:37).
- b. They must care for the poor and needy (D&C 105:3).
- c. They must be "united according to the union required by the law of the celestial kingdom" (D&C 105:4; and 105:5).
- d. They must be taught more perfectly, gain more experience, and know their duties more perfectly (D&C 105:10).
- e. They must also be endowed with power from on high (D&C 105:11-12; and 105:33). (*LM*)

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†12. *Doctrine and Covenants Manual: Religion 324 and 325*

D&C 101:4-5. Why does the Lord Permit His Saints to Be Chastened? The scriptures teach the following about chastening:

1. Chastening is a cleansing process (see D&C 90:36).
2. Chastening may lead to forgiveness of sins (see D&C 95:1).
3. Chastening teaches us obedience (see D&C 105:6).
4. Chastening refines us as pure gold (see Job 23:10).

(In *Doctrine and Covenants Manual: Religion 324 and 325*, 238-239.)

D&C 101:6-8. Why is God Sometimes Slow to Hear His Children? One of the great problems recorded in scripture is mankind's indifference to God in times of prosperity. Too often they forget their Creator, who is the giver of all good things. In times of trouble, however, they remember God and turn to Him for mercy and help in their afflictions, but He is slow to help them. These verses show that the Saints were guilty of this offense. Therefore, the Lord did not support them in their day of affliction. He will not support any who claim His promises but do not keep their covenants. (See D&C 84:54-59; Mosiah 11:24; 21:15; Helaman 4:11-13; 12:1-6; Judges 10:13-14; Isaiah 26:16.) (In *Doctrine and Covenants Manual: Religion 324 and 325*, 239.)

D&C 101:9-12. What is Meant by the Phrase "Sword of Mine Indignation"? President Joseph Fielding Smith explained: "While there was punishment in the suffering the saints had to endure and that because they were slow to hear the Lord, nevertheless the actions of their enemies were not justifiable; and therefore the Lord promised that he would let fall the sword of his indignation in behalf of his people. [D&C 101:11-12.] The sword of indignation commenced to fall upon the enemies of the saints shortly after the saints were driven from Missouri, and from time to time it has fallen, both in this land and in foreign lands." (*Church History and Modern Revelation*, 1:460.) (In *Doctrine and Covenants Manual: Religion 324 and 325*, 239.)

D&C 101:39-42. "The Salt of the Earth" "Ye are the salt of the earth," Jesus told His followers in Palestine, "but if the salt have lost his savour, wherewith shall it be salted?" (Matthew 5:13). Men cannot teach and testify to others of the truths of God, if they themselves do not believe and follow them.

Salt is important to the life of humankind. It has been used through the ages as a preservative, as a condiment, and as a religious offering (see Leviticus 2:13). Salt that has lost its savor, or its saltiness, would no longer be useful. The same is true of those who embrace the gospel and then lose their faith through sin or slothfulness.

Elder Carlos E. Asay explained the imagery of salt and its savor:

"When the Lord used the expression 'savor of men,' he was speaking of those who represent him. He was referring to those who have repented, who have been washed clean in the waters of baptism, and who have covenanted to take upon them his name and his cause. Moreover, he was speaking of those who would share by covenant his priesthood power. He was speaking of you and me.

"A world-renowned chemist told me that salt will not lose its savor with age. Savor is lost through mixture and contamination. Similarly, priesthood power does not dissipate with age; it, too, is lost through mixture and contamination.

"When a young man or older man mixes his thoughts with pornographic literature, he suffers a loss of savor.

"When a priesthood bearer mixes his speech with lies or profanity, he suffers a loss of savor.

"When one of us follows the crowd and becomes involved in immoral acts and the use of drugs, tobacco, alcohol, and other injurious substances, he loses savor.

"Flavor and quality flee a man when he contaminates his mind with unclean thoughts, desecrates his mouth by speaking less than the truth, and misapplies his strength in performing evil acts. King Benjamin cautioned, 'Watch yourselves, and your thoughts, and your words, and your deeds, and observe the commandments of God' (Mosiah 4:30).

"I would offer these simple guidelines, especially to the young men, as the means to preserve one's savor: If it is not *clean*, do not think it; if it is not *true*, do not speak it; if it is not *good*, do not do it (see Marcus Aurelius, 'The Meditations of Marcus Aurelius,' in *The Harvard Classics*, Charles W. Eliot, ed., New York: P. F. Collier and Son, 1909, p. 211)." (In Conference Report, Apr. 1980, pp. 60-61; or "[Salt of the Earth: Savor of Men and Saviors of Men](#)," *Ensign*, May 1980, pp. 42-43.) (In *Doctrine and Covenants Manual: Religion 324 and 325*, 242-243.)